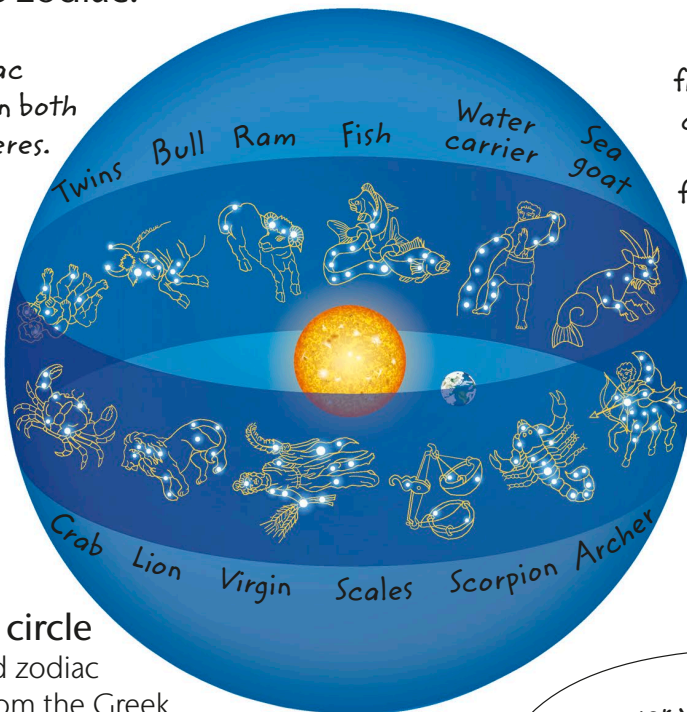


The zodiac

The zodiac is a circle of twelve special constellations. The first people on Earth saw that as the Sun, the Moon, and the planets moved through the sky, their paths always crossed the same starry background. They divided this background into twelve constellations, which we now call the zodiac.

The zodiac appears in both hemispheres.

The Sun moves from one zodiac constellation to another every four weeks or so.



Animal circle

The word zodiac comes from the Greek word for animal. Eleven of the zodiac constellations are animals of sorts (humans are animals, too). The constellation of the Scales was named long after the others.

Whenever you look for the Moon and the planets, you'll find them in the circle of zodiac constellations.